

Business Intelligence overview report

Introduction

Think of a business organization that deals in selling multiple products across many regions. This situation means that the company receives massive orders and data from different sources and has to handle the data especially when decisions have to be made. Therefore, a business intelligence will be very helpful to help the company make quick and informed decisions. This leads us to the question: What is business intelligence?

Business intelligence is the process of collecting, integrating, analyzing and presenting business data to help organizations or companies make better and data driven decisions. Business intelligence combines data from different sources like sales, finance, marketing and operations and transforms it into meaningful insights through reports, dashboards, visualizations and analytics. Generally, business intelligence turns raw data into actionable information that helps organizations/companies understand what happened, why it happened and how they can improve future outcomes.

Why organizations use dashboards?

Organizations use dashboards to:

1. Monitor performance – Dashboards enables the organizations track key performance indicators in sales, revenue, productivity and the customer behavior on different products.
2. Better the decision making process – through the use of dashboards, organizations can access accurately and timely information that will help managers make informed decisions rather than relying on guesswork.
3. Identify trends and opportunities – the use of dashboards helps organizations discover customer preferences, market trends and new business opportunities.
4. Increase efficiency – the use of dashboards helps organizations to identify inefficient processes and make the necessary improvements.
5. Identify where costs can be reduced. Through analyzing expenses and operations, organizations can be able to identify wastes and how to reduce the cost.
6. Understand customers – dashboards help organizations analyze customer behavior and preference allowing them to improve products and services.
7. Forecast and plan – historical data can be analyzed by the use of dashboards to predict future sales demand, revenue among other business outcomes.

Generally, organizations use dashboards to analyze data, improve performance, reduce costs, understand customers, identify opportunities and make better decisions.

How dashboards improve decision making:

Dashboards improve decision making process by:

1. Providing a quick access to information where the important data is displayed in one place, saving time spend searching through reports.

2. Providing a real time monitoring – dashboards show current performance, helping organizations respond quickly to changes or problems.
3. Easier identification of trends – charts and graphs make it easier to recognize patterns as well as increase and decrease in performance.
4. Earlier identification of problems – dashboards can highlight unusual results and areas performing below expectations.
5. Bettering communication – Visual information makes it easier for teams and managers understand business performance and discuss actions.
6. Tracking key performance indicators – managers can monitor important measures such as sales, costs and customer satisfactions.

Business objectives from Superstore Sales dataset

The superstore dataset presents data on 9994 product entries. The objective of analyzing this dataset is to:

- Identify the products with many sales
- Identify profit rate for each product.
- Navigate the regions with more sales.
- Explain to the business stakeholders on the market trends of different products for decision making processes.